

Food Sharing Initiatives in London, England

Multimodal screening report based on 115 submitted candidate URLs and their approximate coordinates. Screening outcome: 33 URLs retained after page-by-page review.



Cook for Good community meal near King's Cross (CSV row 57)



In-Deep community dinner announcement (CSV row 38)



Southwark and London Community Kitchen (CSV row 81)

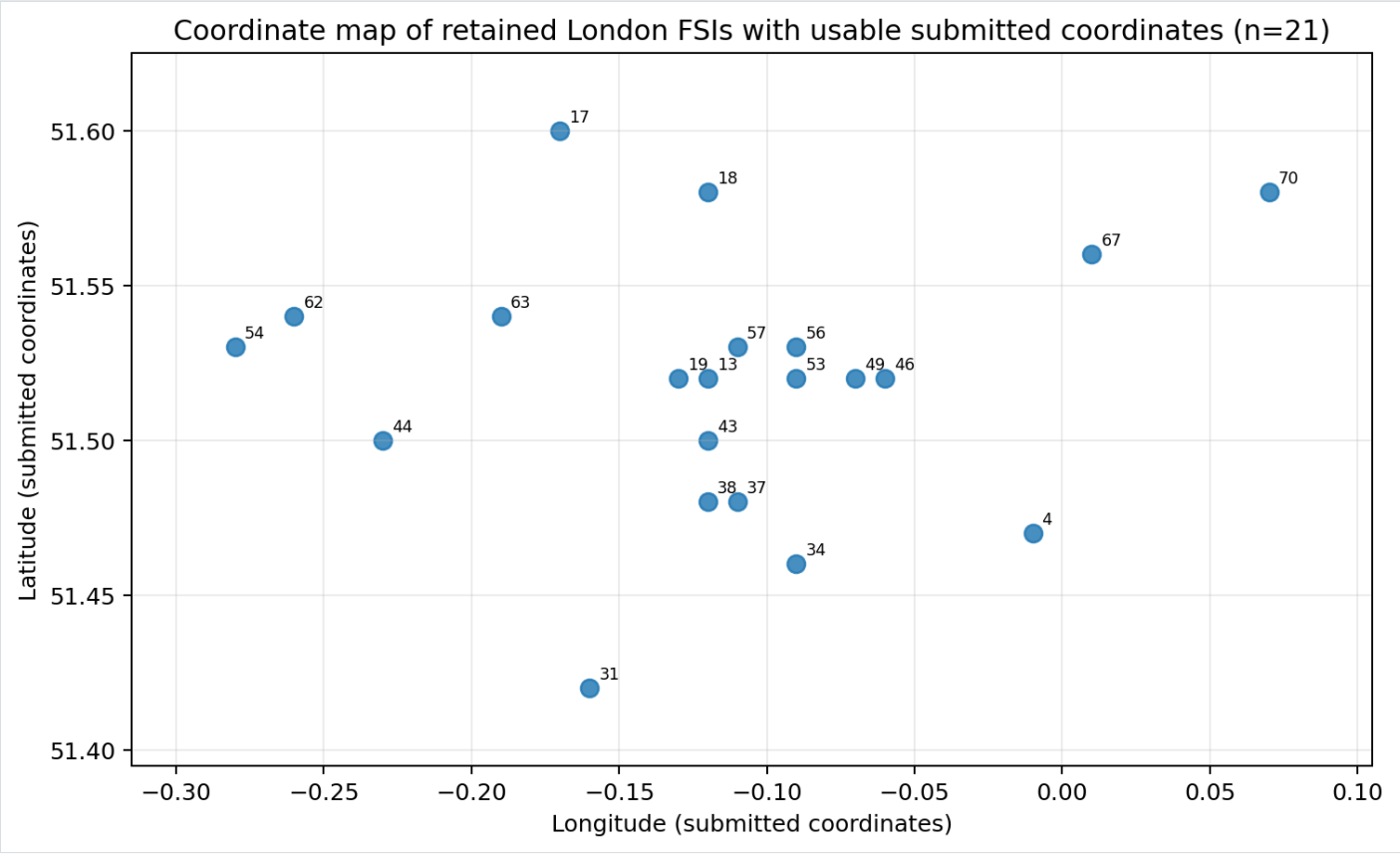


Energy Garden community growing (CSV row 43)

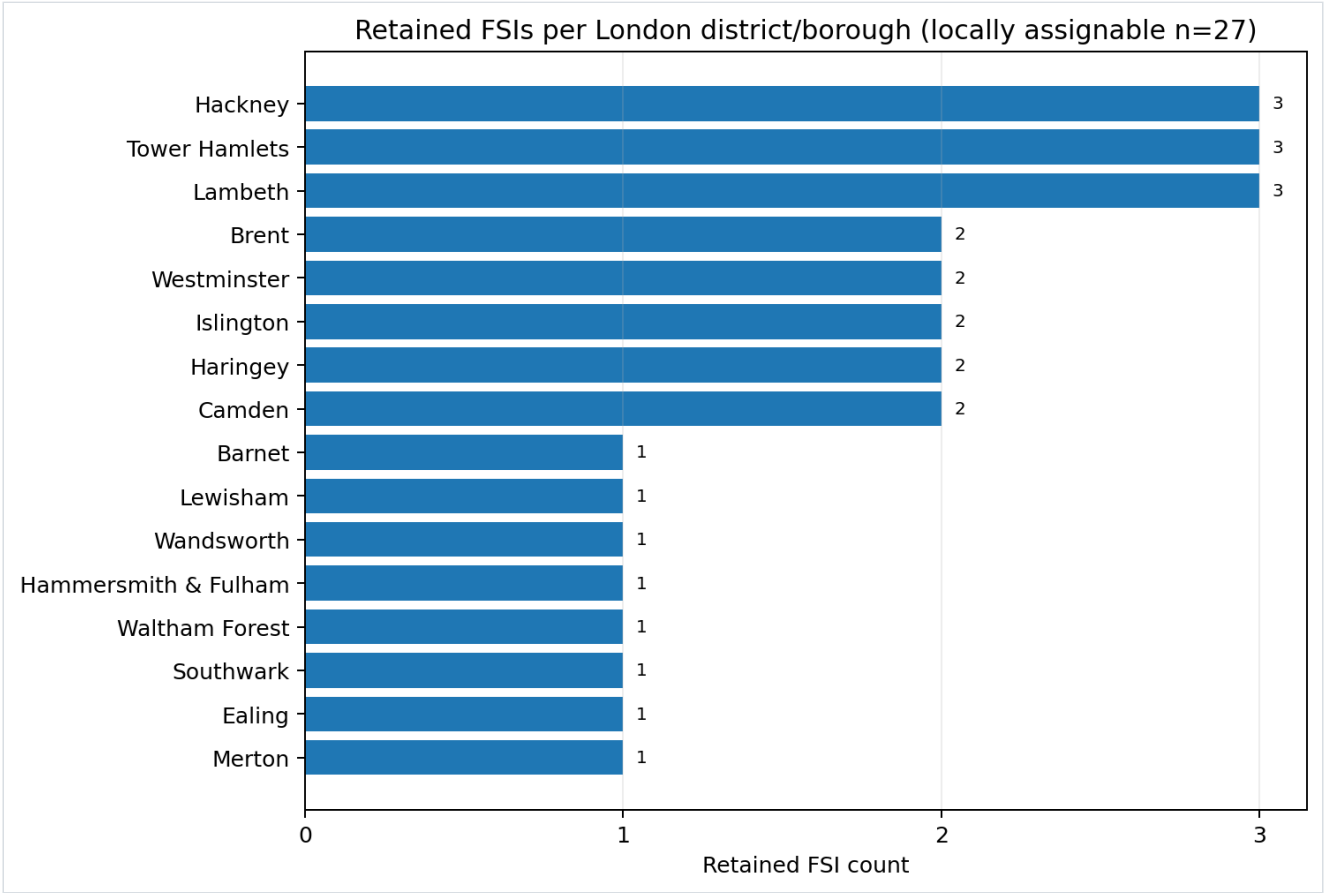
Geographic Distribution

The screening retained 33 of the 115 submitted London candidate URLs as pages describing genuine food-sharing initiatives, while the remaining records were excluded for the reasons documented in the ledger. Among the retained records, 21 have complete submitted coordinates that fall within a London-area envelope and can therefore be plotted without correcting or inventing a location. The London Freedom Seed Bank page describes a London-wide network, but its submitted coordinate is in south-west England rather than London, so that point is deliberately omitted from the coordinate map. For district comparison, 27 retained initiatives can be assigned to a local London district or borough from the supplied coordinates and page-stated locations, while six operate across London or multiple boroughs and are kept outside the district bars. Tower Hamlets, Lambeth and Hackney each account for three locally assignable retained initiatives, the highest district counts in this screened sample.

Camden, Brent, Islington, Haringey and Westminster each contain two retained initiatives, while Lewisham, Barnet, Wandsworth, Hammersmith and Fulham, Waltham Forest, Southwark, Ealing and Merton each contain one. The eastern concentration includes Connected Seeds and Spitalfields City Farm in Spitalfields, Limbrough Food Hub in Poplar and the Transition Leytonstone Community Fridge in Leytonstone. North and north-west London are represented by Hornsey Foodbank, Food Bank Aid, Sufra Community Garden and West Hampstead Community Food Hub, whose pages identify locations in Hornsey, North London, Stonebridge and West Hampstead respectively. South and west London remain visible through Tooting Community Kitchen, Vauxhall City Farm, the Ruskin Park garden, Merton's Community Fridge, the Bermondsey-based community kitchen and the Josiah Braithwaite garden in W12.



Coordinate map using the submitted latitude and longitude values only. Numbers are the original CSV row numbers; the map excludes retained rows with missing coordinates and the London Freedom Seed Bank record whose submitted coordinate lies outside London.



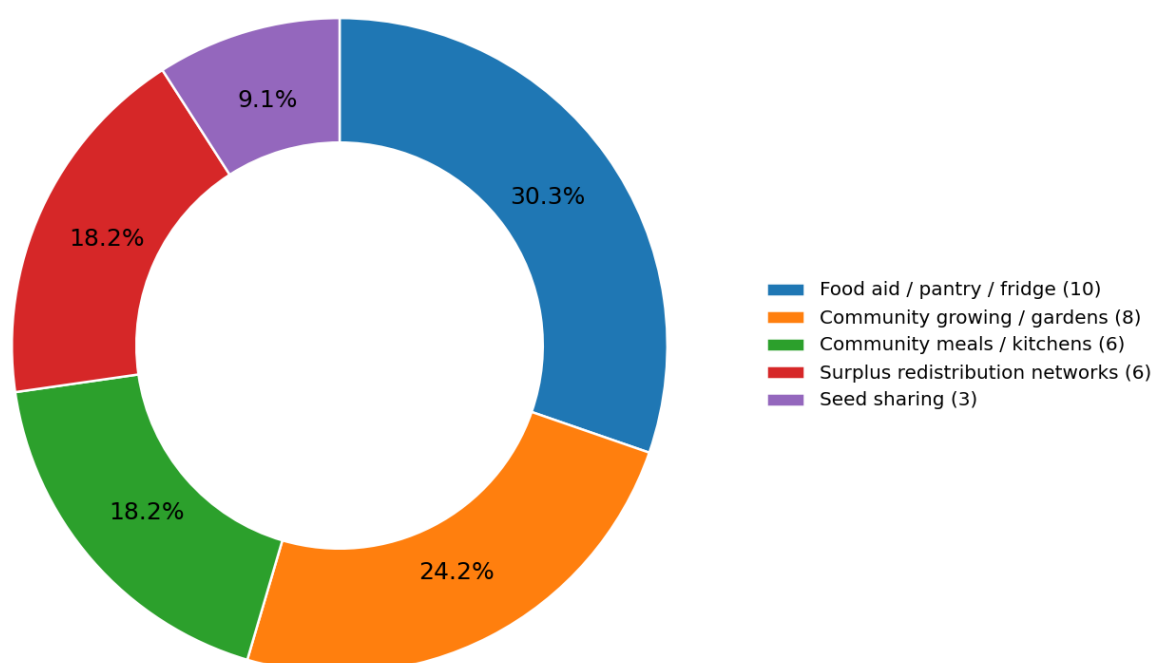
District or borough counts are derived from the supplied coordinates and page-stated locations for the 27 retained initiatives assignable to one local district. Six citywide or multi-borough initiatives are excluded from this bar chart rather than forced into one district.

Types of Food Sharing Initiatives

Using one primary function for each retained record, direct food aid, pantries and community fridges form the largest category with 10 of 33 initiatives, or 30.3 percent. Community growing and garden projects account for 8 of 33 retained initiatives, or 24.2 percent, including the Lambeth GP Food Co-op, Ruskin Park Community Garden, Vauxhall City Farm, Energy Garden, Spitalfields City Farm and Sufra's community garden. Community meals and kitchens account for 6 of 33, or 18.2 percent, with examples ranging from Soup Kitchen London to In-Deep's over-50s dinners and Cook for Good's meals for Pantry members. Surplus-redistribution networks also account for 6 of 33, or 18.2 percent, including Lewisham Food Hub, Food Bank Aid, Felix, City Harvest, Plan Zheroes and UKHarvest. Seed-sharing initiatives are the smallest primary category at 3 of 33, or 9.1 percent, represented by Connected Seeds Library, London Freedom Seed Bank and South London Seed Libraries.

The direct-aid category includes different access models: Hornsey operates as an independent foodbank, Sustainable Merton offers an open-access community fridge without referral, and King's College London makes event surplus and dry goods available to students for free. The growing category is not limited to allotment-style cultivation, because Energy Garden combines food growing at transport sites with community participation and reports that crops have been shared with local people and food banks. Mixed initiatives were classified by their principal page-described function rather than counted twice; Limbrough, for example, combines a pantry, raised growing beds and a training kitchen but is counted once under food aid and pantry provision. The resulting distribution shows that the screened London ecosystem spans emergency and low-cost food access, communal eating, surplus rescue, shared cultivation and seed circulation rather than being dominated by a single delivery mechanism.

Primary FSI types among retained London records (n=33)



Primary-type classification of all 33 retained records. Mixed initiatives are assigned once according to the main food-sharing function documented on the screened page.

Operational and Funding Models

Charitable and NGO-led delivery is prominent among the retained pages: Food Bank Aid, Hornsey Foodbank, Soup Kitchen London, City Harvest, Plan Zheroes, Sustainable Merton and UKHarvest all identify charitable or not-for-profit structures. Community-led models are also explicit, including the Kensal Rise church food project, the volunteer-led Ruskin Park garden, Transition Leytonstone's volunteer community fridge and the South London Seed Libraries network promoted through a housing co-operative. Lewisham Food Hub was described by GCDA as part of the borough-coordinated COVID-19 response and operated through collaboration among local organisations rather than as a stand-alone retail service. Energy Garden describes a

partnership with Groundwork and Transport for London and states that the People's Postcode Lottery awarded a 750,000 pound grant to build on the initial pilot. The Lambeth GP Food Co-op page describes a partnership with Guy's and St Thomas' and King's College Hospital and a network established across eight borough sites, giving this growing initiative a health-service institutional base.

King's College London labels its community fridge project as ongoing and lists 4,000 pounds of funding for September 2024 to August 2025, with the Student Experience team and two Fridge Champions responsible for operation and evaluation. The Woodberry Down Community Fridge page credits Hubbub and funders including the Esmée Fairbairn Foundation, North London Waste Authority, The Funding Network and Sainsbury's, with Bosch supplying refrigeration equipment. Cook for Good identifies itself as a community interest company and says its meals are cooked either by corporate clients during team-building events or by its chef with volunteers, showing a social-enterprise mechanism alongside community delivery. The Southwark and London Community Kitchen explicitly states that its work is entirely dependent on grants and donations, while several other retained pages name partners or volunteers without publishing comparable budgets, so no unsupported funding-share percentages are inferred.

Reach and Activity

Hornsey Foodbank reports supporting more than 1,000 people each week, giving one of the clearest current local measures of recurring food-aid demand in the retained set. Soup Kitchen London states that it supports nearly 200 guests each day, while West Hampstead Community Food Hub says its volunteer team currently helps more than 140 households each week with food parcels. Food Bank Aid reports a network of more than 30 London food banks and says around 20,000 people, including 5,000 children, are supported weekly through its wider North London and Hertfordshire network. City Harvest describes itself as a London food charity and states that it delivers free food equivalent to more than 1.2 million meals a month to people in need. In-Deep says its community dinners have run since 2003, take place on selected Saturdays and can attract up to 100 people to a three-course meal and live-music gathering.

Cook for Good says it regularly holds lunch or dinner for around 50 Pantry members, with meals offered free or at very low cost. Energy Garden reports 30 completed community gardens and 67 participating community groups, and the page also records 2,188 schoolchildren reached in 37 London schools. Plan Zheroes reports more than 500 tonnes of food saved and more than one million equivalent meals provided for 2010 to 2024; those figures are organisation-wide totals and are not treated here as a London-only annual measure. Where retained pages publish only opening patterns rather than participant totals, the report uses those directly, such as Sustainable Merton's twice-weekly fridge sessions and Transition Leytonstone's Friday, Saturday and alternate-Sunday access windows.

Digital Presence and Accessibility

The retained pages vary substantially in digital specificity, from operational service pages with addresses and opening times to older articles that document a genuine initiative at a particular historical point. Tooting Community Kitchen publishes a multi-day schedule covering soup-kitchen, food-bank and hot-food activity, while Sustainable Merton and Woodberry Down each provide exact weekly community-fridge access times and locations. In-Deep lists an upcoming 2026 community dinner at Westminster Kingsway College, and its page also states the booking requirement, time window and per-person charge. King's College London provides unusually explicit project metadata by marking the fridge as ongoing, describing its location in Bush House and publishing both the funding amount and funding period. By contrast, the Lewisham Food Hub article is dated November 2020 and Freedom's Ark still frames its Community Food Hub through pandemic-era language, so these pages are retained as evidence of genuine initiatives without projecting their historical activity figures forward.

Twenty-seven submitted URLs were discarded as inaccessible because the target page could not be read reliably during screening, including several sites that returned verification gates, errors or removed pages. Twenty-one records were discarded because they were directories, policy/resource pages or broad programme listings, and 16 more were readable but did not describe a food-sharing initiative. Ten candidates were outside London, four described activities that had ended and four duplicated another screened initiative, with The Bridge explicitly announcing closure of its FRIDGE project and Hackney City Farm describing its Food Hub participation in the past tense. Social-media-only records were not treated as evidence when the supplied page itself could not be accessed, which keeps the analytical counts tied to material that was actually available for review.

Notable Initiatives

Energy Garden is notable for combining urban food growing with transport infrastructure: the page records 30 completed station gardens, 67 community groups and the sharing of harvested crops with local people and food banks. City Harvest is notable for scale and logistics, describing a London food-rescue operation that delivers free food equivalent to more than 1.2 million meals a month and listing its main address in Acton. Hornsey Foodbank stands out among neighbourhood food banks because its page reports more than 1,000 people supported weekly and describes the organisation as an independent community foodbank sustained by donations and volunteers. Limbrough Food Hub is distinctive for integrating a food pantry with raised growing beds and a training kitchen in Poplar, with the pantry operating two days a week and the wider programme including regular gardening activity. King's College London Community Fridge is a smaller institutional example that redirects food left after university events and other dry goods to students for free, with two Fridge Champions supporting maintenance and engagement.

Merton's Community Fridge combines surplus rescue with open access, operating without referral at Morden Baptist Church and using weekly volunteer and cargo-bike collections from local shops and businesses. London Freedom Seed Bank broadens the concept of food sharing beyond prepared food by organising a London-wide network for saving, storing and sharing open-pollinated seed, while Connected Seeds runs a physical seed library at Spitalfields City Farm. Cook for Good combines social-enterprise activity and food sharing by using corporate team-building cooks or its chef and volunteers to prepare regular free or very-low-cost meals for around 50 Pantry members. In-Deep adds a social-isolation dimension to the landscape through community dinners for people over 50, a programme running since 2003 that the page says can draw up to 100 people per meal.

All initiative-specific statements above are restricted to information visible on the screened URLs or to the submitted coordinate data. Organisation-wide figures are identified as such where the source page does not provide a London-only denominator.

Screening Ledger

Number	URL	Decision	Reason
1	https://www.urbangrowth.london/blog/the-importance-of-edible-gardens-in-urban-areas-growing-health-and-community	Discarded	not an FSI
2	https://londongardenstrust.org/log2024/gardens/Clissold.html	Discarded	inaccessible
3	https://www.thedoctorskitchen.com/podcasts/bonus-episode-why-community-kitchens-are-essential-with-sarah-bentley-from	Retained	
4	https://gcda.coop/2020/11/02/lewisham-food-hub-hits-50000-tonnes	Retained	
5	https://rootsandall.co.uk/podcast/episode-144-sharing-and-borrowing-gardens	Discarded	inaccessible
6	https://www.gardenorganic.org.uk/what-we-do/hsl	Discarded	outside the city
7	https://www.ateamfoundation.org/features/2017/2/1/community-supported-agriculture	Discarded	not an FSI
8	https://www.sustainweb.org/blogs/may21-reflections-food-growing-pandemic	Discarded	directory or policy page
9	https://communityfridgemap.org.uk	Discarded	directory or policy page
10	https://nhsforest.org/locations/lambeth-gp-food-co-op	Retained	
11	https://communitysupportedagriculture.org.uk/find-a-csa	Discarded	directory or policy page
12	https://www.oneearth.org/londons-green-fingers-how-extinction-rebellion-is-turning-protest-into-guerilla-gardening	Discarded	not an FSI
13	https://www.methodist.org.uk/about/our-stories/addressing-food-poverty-one-community-at-a-time-kensal-rise-methodist-churchs-inspiring-initiative	Retained	
14	https://feedbackglobal.org/can-donate-surplus-food	Discarded	inaccessible
15	https://www.lowimpact.org/posts/alice-brown-community-farms-part-1	Discarded	not an FSI
16	https://www.connectedseeds.org/visit	Retained	
17	https://foodbankaid.org.uk	Retained	
18	https://www.hornseyfoodbank.com	Retained	
19	https://soupkitchenlondon.org	Retained	
20	https://churchhomelesscharity.org.uk/mental-health/lottery-garden-project	Discarded	inaccessible
21	https://hubbub.org.uk/community-food-hubs-grant	Discarded	directory or policy page
22	https://ldn.coop/londons-co-ops/food-co-ops	Discarded	directory or policy page
23	https://www.villagecentre.org.uk/group/community-fridge	Discarded	outside the city
24	https://transitiontogether.org.uk/eat-grow-share-communities-building-food-resilience	Discarded	outside the city
25	https://www.londonfreedomseedbank.org	Retained	
26	https://www.alexandrarose.org.uk/press-release-charity-urges-all-parties-to-commit-to-national-fruit-and-veg-on-prescription-programmes	Discarded	directory or policy page
27	https://www.foodmatters.org/projects/food-roots-incubator	Discarded	outside the city
28	https://sutton.gov.uk/w/community-garden-opens-at-oru-sutton	Discarded	inaccessible
29	https://www.thrive.org.uk/get-gardening/seans-story-gardening-for-connection	Discarded	outside the city
30	https://www.surplustosupper.org	Discarded	outside the city

Number	URL	Decision	Reason
31	https://www.tck.org.uk	Retained	
32	https://corbettcommunity.org.uk/2023/03/18/seed-swap-and-share-saturday-25th-march	Discarded	inaccessible
33	https://www.neighbourly.com/solution/product-surplus	Discarded	outside the city
34	https://www.friendsofruskinpark.org.uk/communitygarden	Retained	
35	https://foodcycle.org.uk/community-meals	Discarded	directory or policy page
36	https://www.chelseaphysicgarden.co.uk/plant-science/index-seminum	Discarded	not an FSI
37	https://www.vauxhallcityfarm.org/visit-us/community-garden	Retained	
38	https://www.in-deep.org.uk/community-dinners	Retained	
39	https://fareshares.org.uk	Discarded	inaccessible
40	https://gardenmuseum.org.uk/sowingroots/sowing-roots-esiah-levy	Discarded	inaccessible
41	https://www.thebridge-uk.org/fridge	Discarded	activity ended
42	https://www.facebook.com/humanswhogrowfood	Discarded	not an FSI
43	https://londongardenstrust.org/features/Overground.htm	Retained	
44	https://www.nubianlife.org.uk/josiah-braithwaite-community-garden	Retained	
45	https://www.rbkc.gov.uk/environment/ecology-biodiversity-and-nature-conservation/community-gardens	Discarded	directory or policy page
46	https://www.spitalfieldscityfarm.org/growing	Retained	
47	https://londonfarmsandgardens.org.uk/community-gardens-and-growing	Discarded	inaccessible
48	https://www.npfoodbank.org.uk	Discarded	activity ended
49	https://www.wen.org.uk/limbrough-food-hub	Retained	
50	https://sthildas.org.uk/projects/food-coop	Discarded	inaccessible
51	https://justfact.co.uk/project/limbrough-community-food-hub	Discarded	duplicate
52	https://www.goodtogrowuk.org	Discarded	directory or policy page
53	https://www.slpt.org.uk/support-service/wellbeing-hub-south-islington	Retained	
54	https://thefelixproject.org	Retained	
55	https://www.bowfoodbank.org	Discarded	inaccessible
56	https://www.growingkitchen.org	Retained	
57	https://www.cookforgood.uk/community-meals	Retained	
58	https://families.newham.gov.uk/kb5/newham/directory/service.page?id=DQgbO1ahlJ0&familychannel=2-6	Discarded	directory or policy page
59	https://www.islingtonfoodpartnership.org.uk/community-food-services	Discarded	directory or policy page
60	https://londonirishcentre.org/our-services/community-development/community-fridge	Discarded	inaccessible
61	https://eat-club.org/hackney-community-kitchens	Discarded	inaccessible
62	https://www.sufra-nwlondon.org.uk/our-services/community-garden	Retained	
63	https://westhampsteadcommunityfoodhub.org	Retained	
64	https://www.mildmaycommunitycentre.org/food	Discarded	inaccessible

Number	URL	Decision	Reason
65	https://www.facebook.com/CooperationTown	Discarded	inaccessible
66	https://www.walthamforest.gov.uk/health-and-wellbeing/support-and-community-services-your-area/farm-community-kitchen	Discarded	inaccessible
67	https://www.transitionleytonstone.org.uk/community-fridge	Retained	
68	https://omvedgardens.com/kitchen-garden-guides/seed-saving	Discarded	not an FSI
69	https://ediblelandscapeslondon.org.uk/about-us	Discarded	inaccessible
70	https://www.freedomsark.org/community-projects/the-community-food-hub	Retained	
71	https://www.enfield.gov.uk/services/your-council/community-hubs-and-food-pantry	Discarded	inaccessible
72	https://www.yourlocalpantry.co.uk	Discarded	directory or policy page
73	https://maps.transitionnetwork.org/group/transition-newham	Discarded	directory or policy page
74	https://www.sustainablefoodplaces.org/blogs/jan24-find-a-seed-swap-near-you	Discarded	directory or policy page
75	https://www.ucl.ac.uk/sustainable/case-studies/2022/jul/community-growing-projects	Discarded	directory or policy page
76	https://apps.apple.com/gb/app/too-good-to-go-end-food-waste/id1060683933	Discarded	outside the city
77	https://www.towerhamlets.gov.uk/lgnl/advice_and_benefits/cost-of-living/Help-with-food.aspx	Discarded	directory or policy page
78	https://theseeddetective.co.uk/seed-list	Discarded	not an FSI
79	https://outofmyshed.co.uk/2012/09/23/collecting-seeds-pros-and-cons	Discarded	not an FSI
80	https://www.lendandtend.com/lend-and-tend-blog/mouthy-money	Discarded	not an FSI
81	https://www.southwarkandlondoncommunitykitchen.co.uk	Retained	
82	https://globalplantkitchens.org/stories/what-is-a-vegan-community-kitchen	Discarded	not an FSI
83	https://www.migrateful.org	Discarded	inaccessible
84	https://www.gccrc.ca/foodhub	Discarded	outside the city
85	https://refugeecommunitykitchen.org/uk-outreach	Discarded	inaccessible
86	https://www.kcl.ac.uk/research/community-fridge	Retained	
87	https://cityharvest.org.uk	Retained	
88	https://ediblelondon.org/support-us	Discarded	inaccessible
89	https://hackneycityfarm.co.uk/projects/food-hub	Discarded	activity ended
90	https://www.justgiving.com/campaign/whcfh	Discarded	duplicate
91	https://www.kccf.org.uk/coronation-food-project	Discarded	directory or policy page
92	https://planzheroes.org	Retained	
93	https://www.redmondcommunitycentre.com/community-fridge	Retained	
94	https://www.sustainablemerton.org/communityfridge	Retained	
95	https://www.trussell.org.uk	Discarded	directory or policy page
96	https://relondon.gov.uk/resources/circular-food-pioneer-projects	Discarded	directory or policy page
97	https://www.communityfridgelondon.com	Discarded	inaccessible
98	https://millydays.org.uk/millygiveaway	Discarded	inaccessible

Number	URL	Decision	Reason
99	https://www.xcess.org.uk	Discarded	outside the city
100	https://www.edenprojectcommunities.com/the-big-lunch	Discarded	directory or policy page
101	https://www.cordwainersgrow.org.uk/seeds-saving-swapping-growing	Discarded	inaccessible
102	https://www.moruslondinium.org/foraging	Discarded	not an FSI
103	https://www.incredibleediblelambeth.org/seed-swap-and-a-tribute-to-esiah-levy	Discarded	inaccessible
104	https://www.cfgn.org.uk/how-we-work/our-members	Discarded	directory or policy page
105	https://www.foragelondon.co.uk/the-edible-city-september	Discarded	not an FSI
106	https://notahorticulturist.com/2020/02/28/go-to-or-organise-a-seed-swap	Discarded	activity ended
107	https://solarpunkstories.substack.com/p/solarpunk-sharing-gardens	Discarded	not an FSI
108	https://www.seeds4all.eu/seed-operators/united-kingdom/london-freedom-seed-bank	Discarded	duplicate
109	https://www.londonscommunitykitchen.co.uk	Discarded	inaccessible
110	https://gleaning.feedbackglobal.org/go-gleaning	Discarded	inaccessible
111	https://wefeedtheuk.org/event/food-justice-billboards	Discarded	not an FSI
112	https://abundancedancegarden.wordpress.com/2015/03/28/seed-saving-for-beginners	Discarded	not an FSI
113	https://londonfreedomseedbank.wordpress.com/category/raising-awareness	Discarded	duplicate
114	https://www.sanford.coop/node/27	Retained	
115	https://www.ukharvest.org.uk	Retained	

Screening outcome: 33 of 115 URLs retained.